PROGRESS REPORT

Digital divides: progress report, October 2025 – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *54 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has* **No evidence** *on it in its own report.*

Progress values. *Movement* — some form of progress, however minor, has been recorded. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the repository holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the repository holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Bridging of digital divides

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	A universal-service programme reached 1,400 low-density areas in its first phase, and state media now states that 3,000 out-of-network zones will be covered within 18 months. The programme's position was not held at the window's opening. By May 2026 it had reached 1,400 areas in a first phase, with no target, budget or completion date stated, against 76.9% internet penetration and 10.9m people offline in 2025. The offline figure is a third-party compilation, and neither the regulator nor the ministry publishes a rural coverage, affordability or usage-gap measure. 2026-09-07 - a completion date arrives without a baseline to measure it from. State media states that within 18 months zones classed as out of network will no longer exist, in an operation covering no fewer than 3,000 enclaved and hard-to-reach rural zones whatever their population, aimed at reducing disparities in access between citizens and between regions. On 13 September a ministerial order fixed the calendar of a universal-service tender for mobile coverage of low-density localities, 3,000 of them in lots open to licensed mobile operators. Neither account says the tender is the operation state media described, and no budget or zone list is published. 2026-09-23 - a ministerial order entrusted the state operator with universal-service 4G coverage of 201 sites, each paid from the universal-service fund on acceptance.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	Satellite programmes reached six universities and more than 300 localities without mobile operators, while the universal service fund has published no accounts, grant or disbursement. 2026-07-13 — the connectivity programme is stated at six universities and more than 300 localities where mobile operators are absent, with 20,000 students, against 27 locations and about 366,000 citizens stated to a United Nations body in November 2025. The counts are not the same measure and the repository cannot net them; a separate white-space leg connected 3,972 students at two schools. Alongside it, a commercial access hub opened in December 2025 with 37 firms in the integration process by April 2026, and a first startup was licensed to resell satellite access in July 2026. The instrument built for this has done nothing on the record. The universal service fund and its 1% levy on telecom operators' gross revenue remain on statute, it may make non-repayable grants for non-commercial universal-service expansion, and no accounts, grant or disbursement have been published for any year since 2010. 2026-09-06 — two Zaire province points were back in service after months of battery faults, after a restoration in Bengo; no site count or uptime record is published. 2026-09-15 — the national radio's transmitter programme finished its Luanda phase, aiming to raise coverage from 63 to 76 per cent.	MIXED satellite connectivity reaching new places while the universal service fund has published nothing in sixteen years
Benin	At least 75% of identification services were accessed digitally in 2025, while the regulator's usage report carries no disaggregation by gender or rurality. 2026-02-02 — at least 75% of identification services were accessed digitally in 2025, with the unconnected served by an unstructured-menu channel and by in-person windows. That is the clearest adoption figure on this ledger and it is about one service family. 2026-05-19 — the regulator's 2025 report records rising digital usage alongside the mobile-money figures, with no disaggregation by gender or rurality in the account held. So use is rising and nobody has published who is left out. The one intervention that reached the excluded directly was a charity's card distribution, reported under registration of the population, and it worked because it went to nine communes in person.	MOVEMENT with the divide itself unmeasured
Botswana	The universal fund handed over two school digital centres at P1.45m and P1.5m per site, while the single community wireless site has had no successor in fourteen months. 2026-10-12 — the communications minister said the universal fund's broadband expansion project has deployed 12 mobile broadband and voice sites along the Trans-Kalahari Highway, a P34.5 million investment. A two-day multistakeholder workshop in Gaborone mapped the creative industries to shape a more inclusive digital future (workshop). 2026-07-22 — two school digital centres were handed over in one district at P1.45m and P1.5m per site, thirty machines each, the second framed as addressing the rural divide. The fund is a 1% levy on mobile service providers, no programme total or school target is published, and the repository carried nothing on its school programme before January 2026. Against that, the community wireless site launched in June 2025 with tariffs of P2 to P10 and a free 45-minute daily window remains the only one, with no second site recorded in fourteen months. Two laboratories and one hotspot is the whole of the published inclusion delivery, against an unresolved dispute about what the national penetration rate even is, reported under internet usage.	MOVEMENT
Burkina Faso	White-zone equipment is ordered for delivery before end-2026, while real fourth-generation coverage fell from 53% to 33% and access runs 72% urban against 27% rural. 2026-04-04 — service orders were signed and equipment ordered for the first white-zone tranche, most localities identified, with delivery targeted before end-2026, against a tender dossier for 750 localities finalised and the project not yet launched; a second lot of 750 localities was announced for 2027 with no separate financing line. The zero-white-zone-by-2027 framing sits against a 2030 horizon for full coverage of about 2,000 zones. The universal access fund co-finances half the state's FCFA 37.5bn white-zone contribution, levied at 2% of operator turnover, with no fund account published for any year from 2024 to 2026. Against the build, real fourth-generation coverage fell from 53% to 33% on insecurity, on a figure whose earlier reading no held source dates. Internet access stands at about 72% urban against about 27% rural, not repeated or disaggregated by gender anywhere, and the only household survey instrument the repository names dates from 2013. One donor project closed: a 2021 to 2026 Sahel connectivity project serving more than 3,650 users including refugees published its report, with US$1.2m from one European state, on a pledge made in January 2025.	MIXED a white-zone programme moved into delivery while real coverage fell from 53% to 33% on insecurity

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burundi	The broadband programme targets 80% territorial coverage and carries a digital villages component, with no achieved figure on file. 2026-05-01 — the broadband programme is stated to target 80% of the territory, with a digital villages component under way and no completion date or coverage achieved on file. No baseline was held for either. What is measurable sits elsewhere in this report and cuts the other way: tariffs more than doubled, the satellite alternative costs more than most can pay, and the regulator says the network fails mainly on electricity. A territorial coverage target says where a signal reaches; none of the three says whether anyone can afford or rely on it. The divide the programme is aimed at has one measurement in this repository and it is two years old: 1.51 million internet users at the start of 2024, 11.3 per cent of the population, against 7.78 million mobile connections equal to 58.0 per cent. The regulator's own later statement that very few Burundians use the internet carries no figure at all. 2026-08-23 - a community digital hub with shared computers and digital-literacy training opened at Shombo; no user count is on file.	MOVEMENT on a target rather than on an achieved figure
Cameroon	A FCFA 55bn rural component targeting 328 unserved localities by 2028 went to tender, with no award on file. 2025-11-09 - a limited national tender opened for the rural component of the national connectivity project: FCFA 55bn, 328 unserved localities targeted by 2028 in two phases of 120 sites plus an optional 208, with works expected by 30 December 2026. No award, contract or site count is held after the tender opened. The domestic mechanism that would otherwise fund this is gone: the Special Telecommunications Development Fund stays abolished and universal-service money is not separately traceable in FY2024, FY2025 or FY2026, so rural connectivity now runs through donor projects rather than a domestic account. 2026-09-10 - the state operator says it is extending fibre connectivity to schools, covering communities from the northern to the southern and the eastern to the western regions, presented as digital inclusion in education. It is the operator's own account with no school count, region list, bandwidth, cost or completion target published, so the programme's size cannot be read against the 328-locality figure or against anything else. 2026-10-08 - the state operator and the secondary education ministry signed a framework agreement to interconnect 130 schools in the three northern regions.	MOVEMENT on a tender with no award held, against a universal-service fund abolished before the window
Cape Verde	The universal service fund is appropriated at CVE 122,073,633 for FY2026, identical to the escudo across three budgets. The fund is financed from operator contributions and the radio-spectrum fee, carried in the earmarked-revenue table and in no organic, functional or economic classification, and is appropriated at CVE 122,073,633 for FY2026, identical to the escudo across FY2024, FY2025 and FY2026 - a fee-financed ceiling rolled forward rather than re-estimated. The repository holds the appropriation only: no expenditure, project, governing instrument or annual report for the fund from any date. So the one instrument the country has for connecting what the market will not connect cannot be shown to have spent anything. 2026-10 - a two-month pilot is to take about 250 traders, mostly women, on four islands through training and mentoring in digital business tools, starting on Maio; no budget or outcome measure is published.	NO CHANGE
Central African Republic	The country's first free public access point was inaugurated in April 2026, while the universal service fund is still not operational, with implementation targeted for 2026. 2026-04-24 — the President inaugurated what is presented as the country's first free public internet access point, with technical support from Russian cooperation. It is one site with no bandwidth, uptime, user or funding figure, carried by a pro-government outlet, and the item doubles as campaign copy for a local legislative candidate. The fund that should be doing this work has never operated. The levy was provided for by a 2018 law and a February 2019 decree, its supervising committee's activities launched in July 2025, and effective implementation is named among the regulator's 2026 priorities; it is financed by a 2% levy on operators' previous-year turnover, with scope covering broadband in schools, health centres, town halls, libraries and post offices. It has never published an amount collected, a balance or an allocation in the seven years since the levy took effect, and no collection figure, project award or operator selection is held.	MOVEMENT one public access point opened while the universal service fund reached its eighth year without operating

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Chad	The regulator's fifteenth audit measures coverage province by province, and phase one of the backbone reached Sarh in December 2025. The fifteenth national mobile quality-of-service audit was in the field in October 2025, measuring coverage province by province rather than nationally: 94 points in Hadjer-Lamis, Lac and Kanem with coverage on twelve strategic road axes, continuing into Barh el Gazal and Borkou, and 20 points in Chari-Baguirmi and Mayo Kebbi Est (audit). Phase one of the state digital infrastructure modernisation project was provisionally accepted at Sarh in December 2025, inaugurating the Iriba-Doba fibre line with a live telephony test connecting provincial governorates, on a project launched in July 2020 at 175,106,916 euros; flood-vulnerable sections were flagged at acceptance. No rural-urban split of household internet access is published. About 500 unserved communities have been identified and put to a development lender, against 4G reaching 60 per cent of the population and mobile internet used by 12.6 per cent (request). 2026-09-29 - the ICT development agency inaugurated a community multimedia centre at Moundou under the universal service programme; no count of centres or users is published. About 500 localities remained without a network in June 2026, the outstanding challenge named for the lender-financed programme; no rural connectivity programme for them is on record.	MOVEMENT
Comoros	Five mobile science caravans covering about ninety rural localities a year are being launched under the technology park pilot. The caravans were announced on 24 January 2026 as five mobile units covering about ninety rural localities a year and described as being launched at the technology park pilot five days later, with no caravan count, route or start date confirmed since. They are the only named rural digital-divide instrument in the repository. No universal service or rural access fund exists for this country, no rural coverage figure is published, and the measurement body that would report one was never created.	MOVEMENT
Congo	20 of 76 rural sites are fully operational, against almost 80% of the rural population outside fourth-generation coverage. 2025-10 - the ministry reported 20 of 76 built-and-equipped sites fully operational at a mid-term review, with 56 in advanced stages, an additional US$3m allocated to upgrade sites to fourth-generation service and 16 rural localities across six departments commissioned. No later site count is held, so the position has not been restated in ten months and whether the end-2025 target was met is unestablished. The universal fund was appropriated at FCFA 1,000,000,000 for 2026, its first figure on file, flat for three consecutive years and spent entirely as transfers, and two further towns were connected in January 2026 against 2025 targets of ten multimedia centres and 100 connected sites whose achievement is not established. Rural coverage stands at 33% for third-generation and 21% for fourth-generation service, with half the rural population outside any coverage. 2026-09-15 — the universal access and service fund's cumulative reach was given at a regional emergency-telecommunications workshop as more than 380,000 people in formerly isolated areas now served by communication infrastructure and more than 250 localities better linked to urban centres and essential services. It is the first cumulative figure the fund has put on the record.	MIXED twenty rural sites came into service and two towns were connected while the 76-site end-2025 target has not been restated in ten months
Cote d'Ivoire	Territorial coverage rose to about 95% and the rural programme's first phase is stated complete, against a 575-locality target; the urban-rural gap stays unmeasured. The universal-service agency put territorial coverage at 82% with about 500 localities being connected and now at about 95%, with 500 villages connected under the 2025 emergency programme and 300 more localities planned for 2026. Both figures are the agency's or ministry's own. The target was 575 localities and 825,675 residents by December 2025; no completion statement against it exists and the shortfall passes unremarked in every held account, including the thirty-town account of September 2025. A feature-phone service platform stated for launch by the end of the first quarter of 2026 has nothing on file establishing it happened. 2026-08-28 - the ministry states the first phase of the rural connectivity programme complete, commissioned at Djebakaha in Korhogo, with phases two and three launched alongside it, the second at FCFA 18bn covering 240 further localities across Belier, Poro, Tchologo, Bagoue and Haut-Sassandra against a 575-locality programme target. The account dates that commissioning to August 2024 while reporting it as current, so the phase chronology is not relied on; no site count or subscriber figure accompanies the completion.	MIXED territorial coverage rose to about 95% while the rural connectivity programme missed its December 2025 target and a feature-phone platform did not launch

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Djibouti	A feasibility study for digital houses across five inland regions was launched, under a programme to train 3,000 by 2029 at a stated EUR 7m; no site is open. The initiative did not exist at the window's opening. 2026-05 - a feasibility study was launched across five inland regions, under a programme to train 3,000 by 2029 at a stated EUR 7m, with no site open on record. Both figures are the programme's own. It is the only instrument on this ledger addressed to the interior. The domestic fibre programme has reached the interior one facility at a time - a regional hospital, then a school, sub-prefecture and clinic - and no rural coverage, penetration or affordability figure exists for the country at any date.	MOVEMENT
DR Congo	The fund signed subsidy conventions with four operators for 40 localities, against about 4.3m people with no mobile coverage. The fund was created by law in November 2020 and, per a named civil-society officer, still not available at the window's opening. 2026-08-08 - it signed subsidy conventions with the four operators for a first tranche of 40 localities covering about 258,000 people, with a second phase of 300 sites and a 2030 target of 3,000 localities and 16m people; passive infrastructure stands at fewer than 5,500 towers against an estimated need of at least 30,000. The phase-0 sites were operator-nominated, ten each, rather than scored on the fund's published index. A national diagnostic finds about 4.3 million people in nearly 3,000 localities without mobile coverage, national 2G coverage 77%, 3G 68% and 4G 57%, from about 98% in Kinshasa to 14% in Tshuapa. And a rural solar base-station commitment of up to 2,000 sites was restated sixteen months on with no sites-built count.	MIXED the universal service fund signed its first subsidy conventions while about 4.3 million people remain uncovered and eastern territories were cut off entirely
Egypt	The rural fibre programme reached more than 1,250 of 1,450 first-phase villages and about 5 million fibre lines. The programme stood at 856 of 1,450 first-phase villages connected at end-2024, up from 267 at end-2023. 2026-06-30 - it reached more than 1,250 of 1,450 first-phase villages across 52 markazes in 20 governorates, about 5 million fibre lines and 75% of village service complexes connected, the programme being carried into a deepened lender partnership. No completion date for the remaining 200 villages is stated in any held source, and a 2024 account gives a much larger village frame which the repository does not reconcile with the first-phase denominator - so the share of rural Egypt reached depends on which denominator is used, and nothing on file settles it. The one divide the repository can now measure inside a public system is in schools: primary schools average 95 students per device, against close to one device per student in secondary and in technical and vocational education, which the ministry names as an early digital-equity warning. On the same dataset 36,878 of 42,931 schools meet national smart school criteria and more than 54,000 schools have reliable internet connectivity; the two school counts are not reconciled in the source. It is a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	Twenty of 34 planned towers were live on the mainland trunk road by September 2025. Coverage is being extended along the mainland interior corridor: twenty of 34 planned towers live on the Bata-Mongomo road by September 2025, with the remainder inside the 85 per cent coverage target for end-2026. The divide that is not closing is electrical: rural electrification near 2 per cent against 90 per cent urban, and a mainland district at 2.4 per cent grid access.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	No programme closing a divide is recorded, and the grid delivers 52 MW reliably against 74.3 MW of demand. No programme on the repository is directed at closing a divide. The operator continues expanding its network, and mobile connections are the only penetration figure published, but nothing states a coverage obligation, a universal-service disbursement or a rural target. The structural position is unchanged and severe. The grid delivers 52 MW reliably against 74.3 MW of demand, and the twelve mini-grid centres proposed in answer have no site or date against them. Electricity comes before access.	NO CHANGE

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Eswatini	A second community innovation hub opened in August 2026, against a stated 58 per cent internet-usage rate and 56 per cent youth unemployment. The second hub opened in a rural region (hub, phase). It opened against a stated 58 per cent internet-usage rate and 56 per cent youth unemployment, and the account is the funding agency's own (opening). No financing figure was disclosed for the facility, and no user, training or enterprise-support count is published for either hub (hubs). Two hubs are the country's whole physical inclusion programme.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	A 1.5% revenue levy funds universal access, and handset financing targets 2.6 million devices in 2026/27. From March 2026 both operators contribute 1.5% of revenue to a universal access fund, about 2.5bn birr a year (access fund levy). Financing deals with two banks target up to two million handsets a year for low-income customers on long-term instalments (handset financing). A telco-agnostic wallet launched in December 2025 works on a subscriber module from any network and is verified against the national identity, removing network lock-in (the wallet). 2026-09-03 — the incumbent secured 15bn birr from a commercial bank, 4bn birr of it for low-income users' smartphones, reported 900,000 handsets distributed in the past nine months and targets 2.6 million devices in 2026/27, against smartphone penetration it puts at about 36 per cent. Nothing is published on what the access fund has disbursed or on how many handsets were bought on credit.	MOVEMENT
Gabon	A second universal service phase launched in 2024 to reach 200 villages, against 1,253 uncovered and three of twenty planned sites delivered. The ceremony at Ciudad de La Paz produced three instruments signed by both ministers with their national regulators and operators as principals: zero roaming, spectrum interference coordination and a fibre link. They address the border rather than the interior. No Gabonese coverage, price or usage figure accompanies them. The interior has its own instrument. The regulator launched a second phase of the universal electronic communications service in February 2024 to extend coverage to 200 villages across all nine provinces, financed by a special fund replenished annually by the sector operators, with the two mobile operators tasked with identifying the uncovered areas. The first phase, run between 2016 and 2018, had installed 18 radio stations serving 33 villages on two road axes, against 1,253 villages and about 117,622 people uncovered in February 2024. By December 2024 three of twenty planned rural connectivity sites had been delivered, and in August 2025 the regulator was still taking radio and satellite signal diagnostics across four villages of one canton, with soil surveys and mapping named as the next step. No fund size, contribution rate or disbursement figure is published, and no village has been reported connected under the second phase.	MIXED a universal service programme is surveying sites while the villages it is meant to reach remain uncovered
Gambia	D75 per gigabyte from January 2026 with the floor price gone, against 45.9 per cent internet use. Price moved by order: the tariff decision effective 1 January 2026 sets mobile data at D75 per gigabyte, ends the regulated floor and introduces rollover, on a ministerial directive of 16 October 2025 with the cost-of-service study still pending. Use is the constraint the price is meant to shift: 1.30m internet users, 45.9 per cent of the population against 3.19m mobile connections. Targeted programmes are small and specific — digital skills for women-owned small firms from October 2025. 2025 - the schools' side of the divide has a figure for the first time: 13.2% of schools have internet available for teaching, across a system of 830,895 learners, on the education ministry's own statistics summary. No breakdown by level, region or school type is carried here.	MOVEMENT

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Ghana	The universal access fund is slated for conversion, while its rural telephony project reaches 1,400 of 2,016 sites and is directed to 4G. 2026-09-05 - against 618 sites on air in February 2024 on the previous minister's count, 1,400 of 2,016 rural telephony sites are live and the fund carries a GHS 30m allocation for the project in 2026, with the minister directing every site be upgraded to at least 4G on no stated timetable or cost. 2026-09-07 - smartphone penetration is put at 71.8 per cent in June 2026 against 27.5 per cent a decade earlier. For callers without one, a toll-free voice line now answers in six languages, AI included, without data. A draft bill would convert the access fund into a digital-infrastructure, innovation and skills fund, with levy rate, governance and the rural-access earmark all unestablished. 2026-09-08 - the opposition gave the ministry 30 days to publish how many sites are operational, putting 1,961 as constructed against a target of 2,016 and 46 disputed,; it says the project launched in 2020 rather than 2022 and was financed through a EUR155 million facility from a Chinese policy bank. The repository's own financing record is a EUR 140.8m buyer's credit last reported at 60.2 per cent disbursed in May 2022: the two figures are not the same and neither side reconciles them.	MIXED the access fund is slated for conversion while its flagship project runs on and donor programming was withdrawn
Guinea	Guinea is one of five states whose second submarine cable bids were evaluated at Abuja in July 2026. The evaluation committee meeting of 29 June to 10 July 2026 covers five member states under the regional digital programme, Guinea among them, and assesses bids for capacity on a second West African submarine cable. Domestically, the financing that reaches administrations outside the capital is the US$81m local governance credit whose component split was confirmed in June 2025.	MOVEMENT
Guinea-Bissau	A 2026-2031 universal access fund plan sets targets for closing the coverage gap. The instrument was found wanting first: a legal review recommended restructuring the universal access fund in October 2025. The 2026-2031 strategic and financing plan followed, and the network it would fund is still at tender: the fibre backbone relaunched in March 2026 after two cancelled rounds. Regionally, five states evaluated bids for a second submarine cable in Abuja in July 2026. 2026-09-07 - the first measurement of adolescent access the repository holds is academic: a survey of 2,039 Bissau adolescents finds computer and internet access limited and unevenly distributed, skewed against girls and against pupils in state schools, the pandemic having exposed rather than created the gap. It covers the capital rather than the country, and no official measurement of adolescent device or internet access exists at any date to set beside it.	MOVEMENT
Kenya	588 digital hub sites are committed against a target of one per ward, and smartphone connections passed 50m for the first time. Forty-six centres of excellence and forty standard hubs are under construction, with 10,000 locally assembled desktops procured for the first 100 pilot hubs - committed sites rather than completed hubs. A separate plan for 100 county centres of excellence broke ground at Kikuyu on 21 August 2026, with nothing on how the two programmes relate. The universal service fund connected 20 sub-locations in FY2024/25 and 155 cumulatively, reaching about 508,012 people; no FY2025/26 account, levy rate or balance is held. Smartphone connections reached 50.2m in March 2026 with feature phones down to 28.5m, while American-funded inclusion programming slowed or stopped after the 2025 wind-down - a women's digital-rights accelerator lost its grant and reached three of ten counties. 2026-09-09 - that accelerator is still delivering: a three-day workshop in Tana River County from 9 to 11 September 2026 was to build 100 trainers of trainers to carry its digital-skills curriculum to women micro-entrepreneurs. Separately, a community network at Sipili runs on solar as its primary power, making it resilient to the outages and surges that damage equipment - the account frames unreliable electricity, not absent connectivity, as the structural obstacle.	MIXED hub programmes expanded and a defunded accelerator kept delivering while the fund's own delivery account stopped

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Lesotho	245 of more than 1,800 mapped schools are connected, and the community inclusion model passed to the universal service fund. 2025-11-19 — a ministerial statement reports 245 of more than 1,800 mapped schools connected under the schools connectivity programme, alongside universal-fund community digital centres. 2025-11-20 — the community digital inclusion model moved from a development-agency pilot to full universal service fund management. 2026-07-01 — the regulator's three-year plan makes universal and meaningful connectivity its top theme. The ministry put broadband coverage at 100% against about 50% regular internet use, so the divide these programmes address is one of use rather than reach. 2023 — the regulator's household survey put urban internet use about 34 percentage points above rural, a gap more than double that of 2016.	MOVEMENT
Liberia	Satellite connectivity in Vahun District and a new 4G tower in Maryland County reached previously unserved communities. The Universal Access Fund installed satellite connectivity in Vahun District, Lofa County, a completed deployment rather than an intention, though no cost or subscriber figure is given. Separately an operator opened a 4G tower in Karluway District, Maryland County, bringing mobile and internet service to Karloken City and Wutuken Township where coverage had been limited or absent; this is commercial expansion, not a fund project, and carries no coverage figure. Liberia's first Digital Village opened in Lofa County in May 2026 with connectivity and skills training, on no published instrument.	MOVEMENT
Libya	Household internet at 92 per cent, with off-grid solar and university networks extending reach. The household survey puts household internet at 92 per cent and internet use among women at 74 per cent, which is high for the region and leaves the divide sitting elsewhere than access to a connection. Where the state is closing gaps it is doing so through power and campus networks: 400 off-grid solar systems for remote clusters and border posts, grid work for a settlement cut off since 1999, and a university completing the second phase of its unified fibre network.	MOVEMENT
Madagascar	An affordable-device facility approved nine applications and made a US$2.5m first call, and 664,000 devices had been distributed by June 2026. The facility is a US$24m sub-component of the connectivity project: an April 2025 call closed with nothing contracted, and by November 2025 nine applications were approved with only two operator contracts unsigned, a US$2.5m first call for funds made on 7 November and a student-laptop pilot proposed for about 700 computers (facility). The June 2026 portfolio review records 664,000 devices distributed, against a rural-connectivity tender document that slipped from October 2025 to January 2026 (review, supervision). 2026-09 - a laptop credit pilot for 1,400 master's students opened. A post-office channel, Mahatoky, lets postal staff help citizens with poor connectivity reach public services; it was tested in selected offices and was being extended across the network, with transactional services the stated aim. The account is the consultancy's own and gives no office or user count. 2026-09 - the regulator posted the universal-service fund's 2025 financial statements with those for 2024; the Cour des comptes had criticised the fund's financial governance.	MOVEMENT

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Malawi	A national survey finds the gender gap in phone ownership virtually unchanged over a decade, while the Universal Service Fund is stated to be insufficiently resourced and 85 per cent of schools have limited or no internet. The Universal Service Fund runs a school connectivity project, but the regulator's Director General stated its funding remains insufficient, and no income, balance or disbursement figure is held for any year (fund, skills). In August 2026 the regulator said it is evaluating fund mechanisms to subsidise devices, including a proposed one-tablet-one-student programme. Eighty-five per cent of 9,000 schools have limited or no internet and about 900 have none, with electricity and devices the main barriers (support). A December 2025 survey finds phone ownership at 66 per cent of adults, 74 per cent of men against 57 per cent of women with the gap unchanged over a decade, and a quarter owning a smartphone; the state publishes no equivalent statistic. 2026-09-15 - an independent tower company said it had built 233 sites in 2026, 40% of them in remote rural areas, with 55 more due by early October, 28 of them rural. The figures are the company's own. 2026-09-17 — the ICT minister put the base the identity wallet has to reach at 33 per cent smartphone ownership and 12.5 per cent basic internet skills, at the launch itself. No source or reference date is given for either figure.	MIXED a universal service fund evaluating device subsidies while its own resourcing is stated as insufficient
Mali	The access fund's retained 2026 programme covers 162 localities, 80 access centres and 100 wifi points, on a budget cut by 32 per cent. The instrument is the universal access fund and the window shows both its reach and its constraint. Its board adopted a revised 2026 budget of 27,886,688,000 FCFA, down 32 per cent from the initial 41,151,471,000 FCFA and spread over 2026 and 2027 for security and procurement reasons, with the retained programme covering network coverage extension in 162 localities, 80 universal access centres, 100 wifi points and digital centres, school computer rooms and training for 1,000 young people. The target above it is universal coverage by 2030, with rural and white-zone coverage the named gap. An operator loan carries a women's training target. Nothing measures the divide itself.	MOVEMENT
Mauritania	Border-zone coverage launched in December 2025, three satellite providers were selected in July 2026, and the universal access fund got a new decree. Three instruments moved on the divide in this window. Coverage was launched across southern and south-eastern border zones from Kiffa in December 2025. Three companies were selected to provide satellite telecommunications services in July 2026, after a licence tender in January. And the universal access fund was given a new management decree placing it with the public treasury. External support runs alongside: a Sahel digital connectivity programme with European partners. What is missing is measurement — no urban-rural gap in use is published for the country.	MOVEMENT
Mauritius	Rodrigues was brought into the national digital strategy in May 2026 through a planned cybersecurity framework, a youth project and post office agents promoting the government super-app. A ministerial mission to the island in May 2026 announced a working framework, notably for cybersecurity, with a mainland-based team and an intended dedicated representative, alongside a youth awareness project and post office agents enlisted to promote the government super-app, building on the regional assembly's own roadmap (mission). It is the first national digital commitment to the outer island on record. No connectivity, usage or service-uptake figure for it is published.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Morocco	A second phase of the rural coverage plan was launched in December 2025 with 10,660 of 10,740 programmed areas covered, and an operator refurbished 6,000 internet boxes in 2025. An operator sustainability report published in July 2026 gives 6,000 boxes refurbished in Morocco during 2025 with EUR 1.5m in savings, company-reported (report). Only the group figure of 164,000 boxes across Africa and the Middle East carries a prior year (group figure), so the Moroccan number has no direction. The one urban-rural measure held is the ministry's count of 10,660 of 10,740 programmed rural areas covered; no income or gender divide measure is held for the country. A private barometer puts platform use at 86 per cent of Moroccans, WhatsApp at 83 and TikTok at 32, with 61 per cent saying they do not trust the news they see there (barometer). Sample and method are not stated. The rural gap has a state programme: the minister told parliament in December 2025 that 10,660 of 10,740 programmed rural areas had 2G to 4G service, with a second phase adding 2,000 areas by 2026 and VSAT subscriptions subsidised up to MAD 2,500, on the ministry's own figures. 2026-09-17 - residents of thirteen douars in Beni Mellal province reported phone service cutting out nightly from about 8pm until morning, on a local association's account; no operator statement or regulator measurement is held.	MOVEMENT on the ministry's own figures
Mozambique	Sixty rural mobile stations were awarded and 700,000 subsidised smartphones provided for, against 80 per cent urban penetration and 20 per cent rural. Sixty mobile stations across nine provinces were awarded in October 2025, each with second and fourth-generation service, a public multimedia centre, solar power, a prepaid public telephone and a hundred handsets; the scope had doubled from thirty sites and no completion date is on record (award, tender). A programme provides for 700,000 subsidised smartphones starting at US$5m and able to grow to US$25m, financed through microcredit and pay-as-you-go models (smartphones); no start date, distribution channel or eligibility rule is published (smartphones). The regulator puts penetration at about 80 per cent urban against about 20 per cent rural (gap), and planned and running inclusion work slowed or stopped after a funder's 2025 wind-down with no replacement named (withdrawal). 2026-08-21 — Decree 36/2026 lets the regulator convert operators' fines into universal-service obligations; no first conversion is on file.	MIXED sixty new rural stations and a subsidy programme against an 80 to 20 urban-rural gap and a major funder's withdrawal
Namibia	Twenty-five towers entered service across nine regions, schools and clinics under new towers get seven years free internet, and 100 per cent coverage is targeted for 2030. Schools and clinics under towers built in the previous two years get free internet for seven years, on N$80m in nine radio access network towers over two years (free internet); no list or count of covered schools or clinics is published (free internet). The 2030 coverage target was set in June 2025 against about 360,000 people, roughly 12 per cent, outside 4G coverage at February 2024, with a parallel internet-use target of 53 to 90 per cent by 2030 (target, plan). Siting delays on communal land are the constraint the ministry names, and it met the traditional authorities' trust with the regulator and three operators in July 2026 with no agreement reported (siting). A stakeholder submission to the periodic review put internet penetration above 64 per cent in 2025 but rural household mobile internet access at 16.2 per cent and smartphone ownership below 30 per cent, naming affordability and low digital literacy as what holds access back, alongside a persistent gender gap in meaningful use (submission).	MOVEMENT
Niger	A rural inclusion programme has one centre on record and a second community centre opened at Tahoua, while an analyst warns of systemic exclusion. The rural programme opened a digital centre at Tabelot in Agadez with women's and girls' skills training, and one centre is all that is on record (programme, project). A second community digital centre was inaugurated at Tahoua in July 2026 with 100 computers and 50 kW of solar power, built by an international agency and donor-funded (centre). A named analyst warns of privacy breaches, state surveillance and systemic exclusion under the biometric identity programme, with rural communities, migrants and those without foundational identity most exposed (warning).	MIXED two community digital centres and a rural programme against a warning that rural communities and those without foundational identity are most exposed

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	23 per cent of rural communities have internet against 57 urban, while zero-rated access to educational platforms reached launch and rural job centres are at equipment tender. Every eligibility option consulted on for zero-rated education access requires registration, and the regulator says the scheme may breach net neutrality. A community connectivity hub at Siun, Ogun State, opened on 2 September 2026, one of ten under a UK programme; a second UK-sponsored hub was commissioned at Amuvi, Abia State, in late September. 2026-09-15 - a rural infrastructure firm secured a World Bank-backed results-based facility for 2G, 4G, broadband and community Wi-Fi in 500 unserved communities under the US$750m DARES electrification programme; amount and timetable are not stated. 2026-09-17 - Oyo became the 26th state to adopt the Nigeria Learning Passport, a UNICEF-run platform used by about 2.4 million children and teachers; no active-use figure is published. 2026-09-24 - a multistakeholder community-connectivity strategy to March 2027 was reported moving into implementation, regulators estimating over 100,000 communities eligible; its strategy has no budget. 2026-10-01 - the regulator and the operators' association launched zero-rated access to approved educational platforms, starting with a pilot of 5,000 learners. 2026-10-05 - the regulator's investment forum resolved on a blended funding model for community-owned rural networks, with a six-month target to secure funding.	MIXED zero-rated education access reached launch while only 23 per cent of rural communities have internet
Rwanda	Household internet reached 30 per cent in 2023-24 on a 56 to 19 urban and rural split, while the universal access fund's owed annual report is not held for any year. The household living conditions survey for 2023-24 puts internet at home at 30 per cent of households nationally, against 17 per cent in 2016-17, with 56 per cent of urban households connected and 19 per cent of rural (survey, penetration). Among adults with disabilities, the share with no formal or informal financial access fell from 9.6 per cent in 2020 to 8.1 per cent in 2024 and non-bank formal access rose from 58.0 to 72.4 per cent, while the banked share slipped from 15.0 to 14.3 per cent (survey insights, coverage). The universal access order was gazetted on 15 May 2023, repealing the 2004 order. The fund has no separate legal personality and its staff sit inside the regulator, and the annual activity report owed to the regulatory board by 30 September is not held for any year (order, regulator). A smart-device affordability fund is at design stage with a market assessment pending (devices). The measured position improves while every instrument named to improve it is either unreported or at design stage. 2026-10-08 - the central bank governor said a digital agricultural lending platform is in a six-month pilot, to cut the wait for a loan to under 48 hours.	MIXED household connection and disability inclusion up while every named instrument is unreported
Sao Tome and Principe	The 2012 universal service decree defines the service's scope and its financing fund, and is the operative instrument; no disbursement or coverage obligation is held. The decree defines the scope of the universal telecommunications service and establishes the price-setting and financing regimes applicable to it, and is the basis of the universal service fund (decree). The same gazette issue carries decrees on international call control and SIM card registration. Nothing held records a disbursement from the fund, a designated provider's obligations, or a coverage target set under it (decree). The copy is hosted by the regional regulators' association; no copy was located on a government site. What has reached under-served places instead is a satellite service (satellite) and the operator's own antenna programme (antenna).	NO CHANGE
Senegal	The telecommunications minister put 40 per cent of the population without connectivity during the critical-infrastructure debate, on a 2024 diagnosis that is not held. The figure was stated during the bill's debate and attributed to a 2024 sector diagnosis of coverage gaps and unmet operator obligations. The diagnosis itself is not held, no definition of access is given, and the figure is two years old at the point of its citation (gap). It sits against fourth-generation coverage reaching 97 per cent of the population in 2025 (coverage), so the two figures are measuring different things and no source reconciles them.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Seychelles	87.4 per cent are online and 16,800 people are not, against a universal service fund with no disbursement on record. The tracker dated October 2025 puts 117,000 internet users, 87.4 per cent penetration, and an estimated 16,800 people or 12.6 per cent still offline (tracker). Sections 97 to 102 of the Communications Act 2023 establish universal access and universal service policy, obligations and a fund administered by the communications regulator (Act); the World Bank finds internet cost still a barrier to greater inclusivity despite high coverage (framework). Three years after the Act, no disbursement from the fund, designated provider obligation or coverage target set under it is held. The Communications Act 2023 provides, at Part XII, for universal access and universal service policy, obligations and a fund.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	Internet penetration is unchanged, and the gap the evidence points at is usage against investment rather than coverage. A separate 2024 estimate is on file alongside the current figure; the definitions differ and both are kept dated rather than merged (penetration, estimate). The usage measure sets telecommunications investment against what is actually used; its price series is an attributed opposition critique rather than an official statistic (usage, critique). Backbone reaching 14 of 16 districts against a usage gap of this shape is the argument for device affordability and price over further build, and the only instrument aimed there is a private financing scheme with unpublished terms.	NO CHANGE
Somalia	A smartphone financing programme launched in May 2026, against about 50 per cent of the operator's base still on feature phones and fourth-generation coverage above 70 per cent. The programme was launched by the dominant operator with a financing partner (programme). About half the operator's base still used feature phones against coverage above 70 per cent (devices), so the constraint is the device rather than the network — the same diagnosis several other units in this frame reach and few act on. 2026-09-25 — the partners reported more than 2,500 phones sold since launch and extension through 15 more branches in four states, against a target of 100,000 by year end. The figures are the operator's own, and no interest rate is published.	MOVEMENT
South Africa	Households with no telephone fell to 3.7% in 2025 from nearly 55% in 2002 (figures), while the zero-rating obligation runs late (acknowledgement). The universal service agency gazetted a discussion document on the 2010 determination, with three options and a lean to targeted revision, comments closing 30 October 2026. The consultation, reported 10 October 2026, creates no new funding, subsidy or licensing obligation. The share of households with no telephone at all fell from nearly 55% in 2002 to 3.7% — about 740,000 households — in 2025, with 93.8% holding a cellphone only and 2.5% holding both a cellphone and a landline (figures). The communications minister acknowledged on 27 August 2026 that the zero-rating of public-benefit websites owed under the 2022 spectrum auction is moving slowly, five months before its deadline, while saying he remains confident it will be met (acknowledgement). 2026-09-15 - the community network programme acquired numbers: R7m of UK funding for 25 local community network operators to deploy 250 public Wi-Fi hotspots, connect 150 public facilities and reach 1,500 homes on a shared open-access model. All three are targets; no term or delivered count is stated. Access is not use: online shopping fell to 34.2% of adults in 2025 from 36.6% in 2024, against 79.1% online, and to 23.9% among lower-income adults, on an industry survey.	MIXED household telephone access is now near-universal while the zero-rating obligation owed since 2022 is running late
South Sudan	A US$67 million regional integration project carries the connectivity programme, alongside a 2,400 kilometre backbone and solar power for 500 network sites. The regional digital integration project, at US$67 million, is the active programme addressing connectivity and the digital divide through broadband fibre deployment (mission). The telecommunications undersecretary announced a 2,400 kilometre national backbone connecting to Kenya, intended to shift the country from expensive satellite connectivity toward terrestrial broadband reaching rural areas (backbone), and a follow-on US$5 million investment, US$10 million in total, financed solar-hybrid power for over 500 mobile network sites, improving reliability in areas without stable electricity (power). Every instrument here is external. None is financed domestically, and the usage divide they address is not measured.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sudan	Connectivity assessments began in two Darfur hotspots in February 2026, with satellite services sought and equipment moved. The emergency telecommunications cluster began connectivity assessments from 1 February 2026 in Tawila in North Darfur and Geneina in West Darfur, two of the most critical humanitarian locations (report). The same report records authorisation sought from the foreign ministry to extend satellite-phone services through 2026 and to pilot satellite internet devices and push-to-talk units, and three tonnes of telecommunications equipment moved. The divide these address is not measured: the only national usage figure is a commercial estimate of 28.7 per cent penetration (estimate), with no subnational breakdown on the repository. The central bank governor records that most Sudanese adults remain unbanked and that the upgraded directorate responsible has yet to formulate a national financial inclusion strategy (opinion).	MOVEMENT
Tanzania	Mobile ownership runs at 82.5 per cent against household internet connection at 0.6 per cent, with sharp rural and gender gaps. The census analysis puts adult literacy at 83 per cent, higher in urban than rural areas, with mobile ownership at 82.5 per cent, household internet connection at 0.6 per cent and use of information technology for learning at 10 per cent, each carrying sharp rural-urban and gender gaps. A rights and gender equity centre with EUR 3,000,000 committed is the one instrument on the record aimed at the divide itself. The distance between a phone in four fifths of hands and a connection in one household in every hundred and sixty is where this indicator sits. No programme with a stated divide-closing target, and no disability- or age-disaggregated access measure, is held. 2026-10-06 - the universal service fund said it will build 250 ICT laboratories of 20 computers each in public schools this financial year, where it had supplied about five computers a school.	NO CHANGE the census reading is the first on this series and the gaps in it are wide
Togo	A community network to connect 2,000 inhabitants was announced as imminent in May 2025, as a response to the absence of traditional operator coverage. It was stated by an internet society chapter as a response to the absence of operator coverage (network). Nothing since. A single village-scale community network, announced fifteen months ago and unmoved, is the whole of the divide-bridging record for this country — against a universal-service instrument that appears nowhere in the ledger.	NO CHANGE
Tunisia	Internet use runs 81.4 per cent urban against 61 per cent rural, on a grid that reaches 97 per cent of rural dwellings. The 2024 census puts internet use at 81.4 per cent in urban areas against 61 per cent rural, a 20-point gap, with 40.4 per cent of households holding a home connection; women's use runs slightly ahead of men's. Electricity is not the constraint: 97.0 per cent of rural dwellings are grid-connected against 97.9 per cent urban. The education minister framed the schools connectivity programme explicitly as equity between all regions. No affordability series, no disability- or age-disaggregated access measure and no programme with a stated divide-closing target is held; the gap is measured and not addressed on this record.	MIXED connection is near universal while use and equipment are not
Uganda	The universal service fund retains half the statutory levy with no balance published, and the six-year rural inclusion programme closed reporting 3.4m registered users but only about 29 per cent active. 2026-09-23 — the ICT ministry described a Smart Villages pilot classroom in Butaleja district linked to a Kampala school, with a tower and solar power also supplying 25 households; roll-out awaits a presidential launch.	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zambia	The Universal Access and Service Fund has no fund size, levy rate, annual disbursement or cumulative tower count held for any year, under 2012 regulations that are its regulatory basis. A board assessment tour of projects in three provinces took place in 2026, and no fund size, levy rate, annual disbursement or cumulative tower count is held for any year (fund, projects, bill). The regulations were gazetted in June 2012 and are the fund's regulatory basis; the fund's own size, current levy collected and annual disbursement remain not held (regulations). Fourteen years of a universal access fund with no published financial figure of any kind is the single largest accountability gap in this ledger. 2026-09 — a three-year programme will connect an initial 70 public schools by satellite, adding solar power where schools are off the grid, run by the presidential delivery unit with private partners. No cost or school list is stated.	NO CHANGE
Zimbabwe	A first rural digital hub opened at a Gokwe vocational centre, while the universal services fund publishes no balance or annual disbursement. Contribution rates are set by statutory instrument and the Auditor-General's 2024 report publishes no balance (levy, regulations, amendment, scope). Subscription support covers digital centres and schools, with a further unquantified share committed to artificial-intelligence projects (support) — which is the fund being asked to finance the artificial-intelligence strategy's institutions as well as connectivity. A tower relocation programme is funded from the same fund (towers), and rural network population coverage comes from the regulator's fourth-quarter 2025 report (coverage). 2026-09-29 - a solar-powered hub with satellite connectivity opened at a rural vocational centre in Gokwe, enrolling 50 young people in a free one-year bootcamp and targeting 3,000 learners and 300 teachers, run by the youth ministry with UNDP and a training firm. No budget is published. 2026-10-06 - the ICT minister told the regulator to consider a unit to oversee operators' commercial arrangements and enforce active infrastructure sharing.	MOVEMENT

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